you've left anything of im portance out – say, for example, that you haven't been truthful – they will tell you so and then you've got to write more.

That's exactly what happened to me. They reckoned that I wasn't being completely honest and that I might have left a few important issues out … They also suggested that I explore other issues in more detail. Up until then my life story had been around 20 pages long, but my critics weren't happy until I added six more.

All in all, writing my life story turned out to be a very valuable exercise for me. It's funny … It was only when I got to the bit where I wrote about myself that I broke down. It had suddenly dawned on me that I was causing a huge amount of kak both for myself and for the people I loved. I had never considered what I was putting my family through. I mean, every time I was in the paper because of some or other controversy, my family's name was in there too. Everything I did also had an impact on my parents and my sister.

It was a huge realisation for me – how selfish I'd been all those years. I'd always thought that it was only me going through all the drama, but in reality my family was going through my shit too. The newspaper headlines impacted on their lives too. I wasn't only bringing myself down, but the family name too. When that penny dropped, ja, it was a real wake-up call.

Writing my life story had made this hit home, and it hit home hard. As I said, rehab helps you to be completely honest with yourself, which is probably the best part of it. If you're not open-minded and honest with yourself there, you're just wasting your time.

As the last couple of days of my stay at Harmony approached, I was really starting to itch to get out. I was counting down the days. A week before the end of my stay, I had already started to visualise playing cricket for South Africa again. As it happened, my stay was cut short because I'd heard from Donné that I'd been picked for the ODI squad to tour Australia. I had kind of expected to be selected, anyway. I was a senior player in the squad and had plenty of experience playing the Aussies on their own turf, which had to be a valuable asset to the Proteas. Besides, a month in rehab wouldn't have adversely affected my cricketing skills – in fact, probably just the opposite.

Looking back on the whole rehab experience, it had certainly been a *very* tough month; a very emotional and draining time for me. But it taught me a helluva lot too, mostly about myself. The counsellors kept telling me,